



Mandarin 101: 在校园里 — A Full Campus Introductions Session

Mandarin 101 • Mandarin Chinese

COURSE-OBJ.ZH101.2

Use beginner Mandarin accurately to greet others, introduce yourself, state nationality and current activity, and ask simple yes/no questions about campus life. A complete 90-minute session packet with warm-up, guided practice, partner/lab work, independent practice, extension work, assessment, and a full answer key.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan the session

Course and objective

Mandarin 101 · Mandarin Chinese; COURSE-OBJ.ZH101.2 — Exchange greetings, personal information, and campus-related requests using correct tone, the verbs 是 and 叫, and 吗 / verb-not-verb question patterns.

What is included

Cover; instructor guide; key-term and concept preview; original reading or worked examples; warm-up (2 items); guided practice with organizer (4 items); partner/lab discussion (3 items); independent practice (6 items); small-group extension work (4 items); assessment; complete answer key; access and sources page.

Suggested pacing (90-minute session)

Warm-up 8 min · dialogue read-aloud + vocabulary 15 min · guided grammar organizer 20 min · partner role-play 15 min · independent practice 20 min · extension work 8 min · assessment 4 min.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from the answer key, or distribute through a secure LMS. Review the reading/examples and organizer before class. No paid textbook or app is required.

Student directions

Read or work through the material carefully. Support every answer with evidence, work shown, or clear reasoning.

Before you begin

Key terms

你好 / 大家好 — nǐ hǎo / dàjiā hǎo — hello / hello everyone

欢迎 — huānyíng — welcome

很高兴认识你/您 — hěn gāoxìng rènshi nǐ/nín — nice to meet you (informal/formal)

哪国人 — nǎ guó rén — what nationality (literally "which country person")

可是 — kěshì — but, however

食堂 — shítáng — cafeteria

好吃 — hǎochī — delicious

不客气 — bú kèqi — you're welcome

Concept focus

Mandarin identity and naming: 是 (shì, "to be/equals") links a subject to a category or identity noun (我是学生), while 叫 (jiào, "to be called") is used specifically to state a name (我叫大卫). Neither verb changes form for person, number, or tense — Mandarin is an analytic language, so meaning depends on word order, particles (吗, 呢, 吧), and tone rather than conjugation or agreement. Yes/no questions are formed either by adding the particle 吗 to a statement or by repeating the verb in a positive-then-negative pattern (verb-not-verb, e.g., 饿不饿).

Model 1 — Stating identity/category with 是

我是学生。(Wǒ shì xuéshēng.) "I am a student." 是 links a subject to a noun of identity or category and never changes form for person or tense; time and number are shown by separate words (e.g., 昨天, 明天) rather than verb endings.

Model 2 — Asking yes/no questions two ways

你是老师吗?(Nǐ shì lǎoshī ma?) or 你是不是老师?(Nǐ shì bu shì lǎoshī?) — both mean "Are you a teacher?" Adding 吗 to a statement, or repeating the verb in positive-then-negative form, are the two standard ways to form a yes/no question without otherwise changing word order.

WARM-UP

Warm-up

Answer using what you already know or recall from the previous session.

1. Use the pattern with 叫 to write a sentence stating your own name, giving the pinyin.

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2. Why is there no conjugation needed to change 是 for "I am," "you are," or "she is" in Mandarin, unlike French être or German sein?



在校园里 · 第一天上课 (Zài xiàoyuán lǐ · Dì yī tiān shàngkè) — On Campus, Part 1: First Day of Class

王老师 (Wáng lǎoshī): 大家好!欢迎来上中文课。我姓王,你们可以叫我王老师。(Dàjiā hǎo! Huānyíng lái shàng Zhōngwén kè. Wǒ xìng Wáng, nǐmen kěyǐ jiào wǒ Wáng lǎoshī.)

大卫 (Dàwèi): 老师好!我叫大卫。很高兴认识您。(Lǎoshī hǎo! Wǒ jiào Dàwèi. Hěn gāoxìng rènshi nín.)

王老师: 很高兴认识你,大卫。你是哪国人?(Hěn gāoxìng rènshi nǐ, Dàwèi. Nǐ shì nǎ guó rén?)

大卫: 我是美国人。我从芝加哥来。(Wǒ shì Měiguó rén. Wǒ cóng Zhījiāgē lái.)

王老师: 太好了。那你呢,美丽?(Tài hǎo le. Nà nǐ ne, Měilǐ?)

美丽 (Měilǐ): 老师好,我叫陈美丽。我是中国人,可是我在这个大学学习法语。(Lǎoshī hǎo, wǒ jiào Chén Měilǐ. Wǒ shì Zhōngguó rén, kěshì wǒ zài zhège dàxué xuéxí Fǎyǔ.)

王老师: 有意思!你会说中文和法语,真棒。好,我们开始上课吧。(Yǒuyìsi! Nǐ huì shuō Zhōngwén hé Fǎyǔ, zhēn bàng. Hǎo, wǒmen kāishǐ shàngkè ba.)

在校园里 · 下课以后 (Xiàkè yǐhòu) — On Campus, Part 2: After Class

大卫: 美丽, 下课以后你要去哪儿? (Měilì, xiàkè yǐhòu nǐ yào qù nǎr?)

美丽: 我要去图书馆看书。你呢? (Wǒ yào qù túshūguǎn kàn shū. Nǐ ne?)

大卫: 我要去学生食堂吃饭。我很饿。 (Wǒ yào qù xuésheng shítáng chī fàn. Wǒ hěn è.)

美丽: 食堂的中国菜很好吃。你想不想试一试? (Shítáng de Zhōngguó cài hěn hǎochī. Nǐ xiǎng bu xiǎng shì yi shì?)

大卫: 好啊! 我们一起去吧。你饿不饿? (Hǎo a! Wǒmen yìqǐ qù ba. Nǐ è bu è?)

美丽: 有一点儿饿。走吧! (Yǒu yidiǎnr è. Zǒu ba!)

大卫: 这个菜真好吃! 谢谢你, 美丽。 (Zhège cài zhēn hǎochī! Xièxie nǐ, Měilì.)

美丽: 不客气。明天见! (Bú kèqì. Míngtiān jiàn!)



Guided practice · Reasoning organizer

Work through this organizer together before independent practice.

Given / Evidence

State the given information, quote, or data.

Method / Reasoning

Explain the method or reasoning in your own words.

Conclusion

State the answer or claim it supports.

1. What Chinese phrase does 王老师 use to welcome the class, and what does it mean?

2. What question does 王老师 ask David to find out his nationality, and what is the literal meaning of the words?

3. Explain how "哪国人" combines "which," "country," and "person" into a single question phrase, and how this differs from English word order.

4. Translate Meili's response explaining she is Chinese but studies French: "我是中国人,可是我在这个大学学习法语。"

Partner / lab discussion

Discuss each item with a partner or lab group before writing a joint response.

1. Discuss with a partner: why might David introduce himself with "很高兴认识您" (using 您) to the teacher, but Meili and David would likely use 你 with each other?

2. With a partner, practice asking "你饿不饿?" (are you hungry or not?) and answering truthfully. Explain the grammar pattern used.

3. Discuss what 王老师's comment "你会说中文和法语,真棒" reveals about Meili, and translate it.



Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

1. Where does David say he is from, and what is the pinyin for the city name?

2. What does David want to do after class, and where?

3. What does Meili want to do after class, and where?



Independent practice

Work independently. Show your work or cite evidence in every answer.

4. Translate Meili's line: "食堂的中国菜很好吃。你想不想试一试?"

5. Identify the particle 吧 in "我们一起去吧" and explain its function.

6. What does David say to thank Meili at the end, and how does she respond?



Small-group extension work

Use for review or additional application practice.

1. Write a short exchange using 吗 to ask a yes/no question and answer it, based on the pattern in the dialogue.

2. Rewrite "你饿不饿?" using 吗 instead of the verb-not-verb pattern, and explain if the meaning changes.



Small-group extension work

Use for learners ready for additional challenge or synthesis.

1. Explain why Mandarin relies on tone rather than verb conjugation or gendered articles to distinguish meaning, and give one tone-pair example from the vocabulary or dialogue.

2. Compare "我是学生" (I am a student) and "我叫大卫" (I am called David) using the 是 vs. 叫 explanation, then write one additional original sentence using each verb correctly.



Assessment

Complete independently to show what you learned today.

1. Write a short four-line original dialogue in Mandarin (with pinyin) in which two students meet for the first time, exchange names using 叫, ask where each other is from using 哪, and close politely.



Assessment · self-assessment

Rate today's work:

4 — I can teach this to someone else.

3 — I can do this independently.

2 — I can do this with help.

1 — I need to revisit this before the next session.



Answer key

1. Answers vary; must use 叫 correctly, e.g., 我叫 Alex. (Wǒ jiào Alex.) 叫 is invariant — it never changes form regardless of who is speaking.
2. Mandarin verbs do not change form for person or number — 是 (shì) stays exactly the same whether the subject is 我 (I), 你 (you), or 她 (she); grammatical relationships are shown by word order and particles, not verb endings.
3. "大家好!欢迎来上中文课。" (Dàjiā hǎo! Huānyíng lái shàng Zhōngwén kè.) = "Hello everyone! Welcome to Chinese class."
4. "你是哪国人?" (Nǐ shì nǎ guó rén?), literally "you are which country person?" = "What is your nationality?"
5. 哪 (which) + 国 (country) + 人 (person) stack directly with no preposition, unlike English "What country are you from?"; Mandarin regularly builds phrases this way, letting word order alone carry meaning.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

6. "I am Chinese, but I study French at this university."

7. 您 is the polite/formal form of "you," appropriate for addressing a teacher or elder; 你 is the standard informal form used between peers — similar to the vous/tu distinction in French or Sie/du in German.

8. This is the "verb-not-verb" (positive-negative) question pattern (饿不饿), a common way to ask a yes/no question in Mandarin without needing the particle 吗.

9. "You can speak Chinese and French, that's really great." It shows the class values multilingualism, and that being a native Chinese speaker doesn't exempt Meili from also being a language learner (of French).

10. 芝加哥 (Zhījiāgē) — Chicago.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

11. 去学生食堂吃饭 (qù xuéshēng shítáng chī fàn) — go to the student cafeteria to eat.
12. 去图书馆看书 (qù túshūguǎn kàn shū) — go to the library to read/study.
13. "The cafeteria's Chinese food is very delicious. Do you want to try it?"
14. 吧 softens a statement into a suggestion, similar to "let's..." in English; "我们一起去吧" = "Let's go together."
15. "谢谢你, 美丽" (Xièxie nǐ, Měilì) — "Thank you, Meili"; she responds "不客气" (Bú kèqi) — "You're welcome."

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

16. Answers vary; must use 吗 correctly, e.g., "你是老师吗?" / "不是,我是学生。"

17. "你饿吗?" — the meaning is the same (Are you hungry?); 吗 and verb-not-verb are two equally common ways to form yes/no questions, interchangeable in most contexts.

18. Mandarin is a tonal, analytic language: each syllable carries a pitch contour that changes its meaning entirely (e.g., 妈 mā "mother" vs. 骂 mà "to scold"), while grammatical relationships come from word order and particles rather than word endings — unlike French or German, no noun-adjective agreement or verb conjugation is needed.

19. Answers vary; must show 是 used for identity/category and 叫 used for naming, e.g., "我是老师。" / "我叫王美丽。"

20. Answers vary; must include a greeting, a name exchange using 叫, an origin question/answer using 哪 or 哪国, and a polite closing (e.g., 再见 or 明天见).

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Access, sources, and license

Extension

Ask for a second method, a counterexample, or a short student-led extension of the concept, with a brief explanation of the choice.

Accommodated seating/504

Follow the individual accommodation plan: extended time, breaks, enlarged print, reduced copying, or an alternate response method as documented.

Additional support

Pre-teach key vocabulary or notation before class. Model the first guided item aloud. Accept oral or dictated responses when appropriate.

Multilingual learners

Preview key terms with examples. Allow brief first-language discussion before independent writing. Provide sentence or solution starters.

Course-level alignment · accessed September 18, 2026

COURSE-OBJ.ZH101.2 — Exchange greetings, personal information, and campus-related requests using correct tone, the verbs 是 and 叫, and 吗 / verb-not-verb question patterns. The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the course-level goal.

Course-level learning objective written for this packet; no accreditation, transfer credit, or universal course-equivalency is claimed.

Original reading(s)/worked examples, questions, and answer explanations. No textbook or copyrighted course material reproduced.

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